Vaultbreakers

Curio's Conjured Carnival

Mission: 002 | **Tier:** 2

An Heist-Based Adventure Module by Arcadev

CLASSIFIED

DAGGERHEART COMPATIBLE

VAULTBREAKERS: CURIO'S CONJURED CARNIVAL

A Heist-Based Adventure Module

Art, Design and Writing by Arcadev

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VAULTBREAKERS: CURIO'S CONJURED CARNIVAL

A Mystical Heist Set Inside Curio's Conjured Carnival

GENERAL OVERVIEW

Themes: Heist, espionage, infiltration, teamwork

Touchstones: The Wild Beyond the Witchlight, Ocean's 11 Series, James Bond, Now You See Me

Players: 3-5

Level: 2-4 (Tier 2)

Beginning the Adventure

Players should design characters who fit the tone, and demands of a heist crew. Characters should pick **Domain Cards** and **Experiences** that make sense for planning, infiltrating, and executing a heist.

Read or share before playing:

Varrisgate is a city of spectacle, where magic and industry thrive side by side. The city is no stranger to magical events but once every year, something far mystical arrives.

In a burst of color and light, Curio's Conjured Carnival — a dimension-hopping fair — appears in Varrisgate, settling neatly into the space reserved for it in the city.

Run by the eccentric genie Curio, the carnival is a marvel of magical attractions and performances. No two visits are ever the same, and people travel from across Varrisgate and beyond to witness its wonders. This year is no different. The star attraction this time, a legendary flying serpent — the Al-Thueban.

But behind the lights and laughter, powerful figures in Varrisgate have taken an interest in the creature.

That's where you come in.

You're part of a crew connected to the Vaultbreakers, an underworld syndicate specializing in high-risk heists. Your task: infiltrate the carnival, steal the Al-Thueban, and extract it before the carnival vanishes once more.

Adventure Overview

Act I: THE PLAN

The party is hired by the Vaultbreakers Association to steal an Al-Thueban, a giant flying serpent that lays diamond eggs from Curio's Conjured Carnival. They must look over the intel provided, gear up, and plan their heist.

Act II: THE HEIST

Curio's Carnival is open to the public which means the heist is underway! The party can explore this funland and go about stealing the Al-Thueban.

Act III: THE RIVALS

It seems the party is not the only ones with their eyes on the Al-Thueban. The Velvet Daggers, another thieving crew, seems to be pursuing a similar goal.

Act IV: THE COMPLICATION

A problem that happened at the carnival's last stop seems to be back. Axolari from the Wandersea have made their way to the Material Plane and want their revenge on the Carnival.

Act V: THE EXFILTRATION

Whether behind the distraction of the Axolari or out in the open for all to see, the party must try to escape the Carnival with the Al-Thueban without getting caught.

THE PLAN

ACT I

The Beginning

This adventure starts in your players' secret hideout where they are awaiting a message from the Vaultbreakers Association.

Read this aloud to your players:

> A shadowy figure flickers to life in the middle of your hideout.
>
> "Operatives, the Vaultbreakers have a new job for you. As I'm sure you're aware, Curio's Conjured Carnival is coming to Varrisgate, bringing a creature called an Al-Thueban with it. Our client wants this beast. Your task is simple: get the creature and extract it safely."
>
> The projection glitches. "Details and gear are on the way." Then it vanishes.

Go around the table and have each player introduce their character, describe how they look and what they're doing or thinking. This helps everyone picture the party and get into character.

Let them roleplay together and share their thoughts about the mission.

When they're finished, read the following aloud:

> A small arcane rift splits open above your table. A stack of sealed files, coins for the carnival tickets and a small iridescent pearl tumble out. The rift snaps shut, leaving only the scent of ozone.

Once the files and items have been delivered you can move on to the **PLANNING PHASE.**

Planning Phase

The Vaultbreakers Association provides the party with a detailed dossier containing **Curio's Carnivals Layout**, the **Carnival Event Timetable**, and the **Containment Pearl.**

See the Carnival Layout in the appendix.

HEIST EQUIPMENT
The party can buy equipment for their upcoming heist. They have a limited number of **Heist Points** they can spend on items.

Heist Points
A group gets Heist Points equal to **twice the number of players + 2.**

For example **4 players** get **10 Heist Points**

They can buy:

- **Minor Health Potion:** 1 Heist Point
- **Minor Stamina Potion:** 1 Heist Point
- **Glamour Stone:** 2 Heist Points
- **Lorekeeper:** 3 Heist Points
- **Gecko Gloves:** 2 Heist Points
- **Lakestrider Boots:** 2 Heist Points
- **Speaking Orbs:** 1 Heist Point
- **Ring of Silence:** 3 Heist Points
- **Self Wrapping Rope:** 2 Heist Points
- **Ghost Gaze Goggles:** 2 Heist Points

Let your party plan, choose their items and decide their exfiltration method. Once they are done move on to **ACT II: THE HEIST.**

THE HEIST

ACT II

Curio's Conjured Carnival

Curio's Conjured Carnival is a dimension-traveling fair that appears for a single day before vanishing to the next plane.

Today, it has arrived in Varrisgate City on the Material Plane. But after a disastrous event in its last destination, Curio and the carnival staff are tense, clearly trying to keep things from unraveling again.

CURIO THE GENIE

Curio is the extravagant yet enigmatic genie who runs Curio's Conjured Carnival. Their origins remain a mystery, and when pressed, they spin absurd tales involving gargantuan turtles, axolotls, or both.

Read this when players first see Curio:

> Curio is a portly, light-orange genie whose form appears half-solid, half-ethereal—wisps of cloudlike vapor drifting through their slightly translucent body. They wear a showman's attire: a tall black top hat and a fitted black tailcoat that somehow sits perfectly upon their shifting frame. In one hand, they carry a polished golden cane, which they idly twirl with practiced flair.
>
> Below the waist, their body tapers into a swirling plume of smoke rather than legs, coiling and curling as they float effortlessly above the ground.

Curio drifts through the Carnival overseeing events and putting out fires.

Curio is always flanked by **1 Carnival Constable, 1 Carnival Clown,** and **1 Carnival Conjurer.**

They also know the **secret passphrase** to access the Planar Warehouse.

When a PC first sees or speaks with Curio, have them make an **Instinct Reaction Roll (DC 11).** On a success, they notice Curio repeatedly glancing at the sky, visibly tense.

This unease comes from the Carnival's last disastrous stop — Curio fears an attack by the Axolari.

Still, they refuse to share this worry, determined to keep the Carnival feeling safe.

CARNIVAL STAFF

Curio's Conjured Carnival employs three types of staff:

- **Carnival Constables** – The Carnival's guards. They wear blue officer uniforms with peaked caps and carry metal batons, focusing on protecting the grounds and its guests.
- **Carnival Clowns** – Acrobatic entertainers in bright, baggy costumes and red noses. Beneath the antics, they carry concealed scythes to handle threats.
- **Carnival Conjurers** – Magicians in cloaks and top hats, wielding wands and summoning Conjured Rabbits for both showmanship and combat.

These staff members are stationed all around the carnival. Spend **1 Fear** to summon **2 of any type.**

WHAT HAPPENED AT THE LAST CARNIVAL EVENT
Before arriving on the Material Plane, Curio's Conjured Carnival visited the **Wandersea** — a plane of drifting constellations.

They hosted a celebration for the Axolari — anthropomorphic Axolotls native to the plane — but disaster struck when the Axolari Princess fell from the Wyvern's Wake due to an unsecured restraint. She survived, but was badly injured.

Believing it an assassination attempt, the Axolari attacked the carnival.

Getting into the Carnival

CARNIVAL TICKETS
The Vaultbreakers give each PC enough coin for one ticket. Buying one at the Front Gate booth causes a glowing golden bangle to appear on their wrist as proof of entry.

SNEAKING IN
A magical ward around the carnival grounds blocks entry anywhere but the main gate.

A PC with a Spellcast Trait can **Disrupt the Ward** with a successful **Knowledge Roll (DC 17).**

- **Fail with Fear :** Mark 1 Stress and 1 HP.
- **Fail with Hope:** Mark 1 Stress.
- **Success:** Create a door-sized opening long enough for the party to pass.

PC's can also try **Slipping Through the Gate** with a successful **Finesse Roll (DC 15)** or **Talking Their Way In** with a successful **Presence Roll (DC 22).** On a failure, staff demand a ticket or escalate accordingly.

Carnival Attractions

CURIO'S CARNIVAL
Read this aloud when players first fully see the Carnival:

> Curio's Conjured Carnival sprawls across the grounds in a riot of color, lantern lights, and drifting music. Bright banners flow in the breeze above striped tents, and the scent of sugar, oil, and lake water mingles in the air. Soft golden lights outline every attraction, casting everything in a warm, dreamlike glow.
>
> Living wooden horses circle on a nearby painted carousel while catfish-shaped boats glide across a lantern-lit lake in the distance. A towering Ferris Wheel turns steadily, overlooking the grounds, and the skeletal frame of the Wyvern's Wake twists across a part of the space. Laughter and screams echo from the nearby Mirror Maze, while small stalls line the walkways, their barkers calling out challenges of strength, agility and wit.
>
> Uniformed guards patrol with steady eyes, brightly dressed performers somersault through the crowds, and cloaked conjurers dazzle groups of visitors across the space.
>
> Despite the cheer and spectacle, there's a faint tension beneath it. Staff members glance skyward more often than they should, and conversations occasionally drop to hushed tones. The carnival dazzles and delights, but something feels just slightly off.

CAROUSEL
Curio's Carnival features a magical carousel of living wooden horses. Players can ride it for one ticket punch each.

Read this aloud when players see the Carousel up close:

> Brightly painted in swirling reds and golds, the carousel turns to lively, slightly tinny carnival music. Wooden horses rise and fall on polished brass poles, their carved eyes blinking and tails flicking.
>
> Nearby, a small crate of fresh hay rests against the railing.

The horses enjoy being fed hay — even if they can't truly eat it. A character who can speak with animals (such as through ***Nature's Tongues***) can coax one into sharing what it knows about the Axolari situation with a successful **Presence Roll (Difficulty 10)**.

Riding this attraction ticks down the Carnival Countdown by 1.

CATFISH LAKE
Curio's Carnival has a lake with catfish-shaped boats. Players can ride it for one ticket punch each.

Read this aloud when players see Catfish Lake up close:

> Soft lantern light reflects off the still waters of Catfish Lake, where small wooden boats slowly drift around. Each vessel is shaped like a massive, wide-mouthed catfish, with carved whiskers curling from their bows and painted eyes that occasionally blink. Their tails gently paddle beneath the surface, moving the boats along without oars.

One catfish boat is half-sunken and being pulled under. If the players try to free it, **Tangleblight** rise from the water and attack.

Encounter
- **1 Tangleblight** per PC

If the party helps pull the boat free, the ride overseer rewards them with **Arcane Facepaint**.

Riding this attraction ticks down the Carnival Countdown by 1.

MIRROR MAZE
Curio's Carnival has a Mirror Maze. Players can enter it for one ticket punch each.

Read this aloud when players enter the Mirror Maze up close:

> Tall, glittering panels form the entrance to the Mirror Maze, their surfaces warped. Inside, reflections stretch, and split into endless duplicates, making every turn feel uncertain. Soft lights flicker across the glass, and distant laughter echoes from no clear direction.

Inside the Mirror Maze, the party meets a distressed Fungril woman searching for her missing daughter, Lumeria. If they choose to help, they'll find the girl deeper within — cornered by Reflection Revenants lurking among the glass.

Encounter
- **1 Reflection Revenant** per PC

If the party saves Lumeria, she will reward them with a **Ser Cuddles**.

Entering this attraction ticks down the Carnival Countdown by 1.

SMALL STALLS

Curio's Carnival has 6 small stalls running Carnival games. Each is a game requiring one of the six traits. One game costs one punch of the carnival ticket.

- **Agility** - Catch the Golden Goose
- **Strength** - Pull the sword from the stone
- **Finesse** - Toss rings onto the three Jackalopes' Horns
- **Instinct** - Spot three golden water sprites in a jar of a swarm.
- **Presence** - Put the baby Mandrake to sleep.
- **Knowledge** -

For each game start a **Progress Countdown (3)** to winning and a **Consequence Countdown (4)** to losing. Each game has a **(Difficulty 14).**

Upon winning a game, roll a **1d6** on the **Carnival Prizes Table**. This is the winner's prize.

Carnival Prizes

Roll	Prize
1	**Ser Cuddles**
2	**Arcane Cloak**
3	**Arcane Facepaint**
4	**Calming Pendant**
5	**Major Charm Potion**
6	**Water Sprite in a Bag**

Playing 2 Stall Games ticks down the Carnival Countdown by 1.

FERRIS WHEEL

Curio's Carnival has a Ferris Wheel. Players can ride it for one ticket punch each.

Read this aloud when players see the Ferris Wheel up close:

> The Ferris Wheel rises above the carnival, its metal frame lined with steady golden lights. Gondolas circle slowly, each large enough to seat several guests. From the top, riders can see the entire carnival grounds spread out below.

As the Ferris Wheel nears the top, an event triggers. Grestin, a Simiah, snatches a necklace from Amma, a Galapa, and tries to climb down as she calls for help.

If the party intervenes, start a **Progress Countdown (4)** to catch him and a **Consequence Countdown (6)** for his escape.

Curio catches any player who falls from the ride. Each roll to further the countdowns is a **Difficulty 14.**

If caught, Grestin, the Simiah returns the necklace and is taken by Constables. Amma rewards the party with a **Calming Pendant.**

Riding this attraction ticks down the Carnival Countdown by 1.

WYVERN'S WAKE
Curio's Carnival has a rollercoaster ride called the Wyvern's Wake. Players can ride it for one ticket punch each once it is operational:

Read this aloud when players see the Wyvern's Wake up close:

> The Wyvern's Wake looms over the carnival, but its cars sit motionless on the tracks — rusted and swaying slightly in the breeze. A faded sign warns that the ride is out of order, and the faint scent of oil and burnt metal hangs in the air.

The Wyvern's Wake is out of order, and a carnival staff member struggles to pull a spear from the ride's power box.

Players can help with a **Strength Roll (Difficulty 16)**. Three failures in a row snap the spear in half, but success lets a player claim an **Improved Spear**.

Once the spear is out the staff member can fix the ride and it becomes operational.

Riding this attraction ticks down the Carnival Countdown by 1.

Carnival Countdown

Some carnival events happen at set times. Track them with the Carnival Countdown.

The Countdown starts at **6** and ticks down as time passes or certain actions occur.

Timer	Event
6	Nothing
5	**THE SNAKE'S ARRIVAL**
4	Nothing
3	**THE PARADE**
2	Nothing
1	**THE BIG TOP SHOW**

The Carnival Countdown ticks down when certain actions are taken, when the party takes a Short Rest, or whenever time meaningfully passes (about 1 hour per tick).

At set points, **Special Events** occur: The **Snake's Arrival**, the **Parade**, and the **Big Top Show**. During these moments, the Al-Thueuban is out in public instead of inside the Planar Warehouse — offering rare chances to strike.

Capturing the Al-Thueban

The Al-Thueban can be captured with the **Containment Pearl**. It must make a roll **(Difficulty 11)** to resist. Disadvantage if below half health.

Alternatively, a character who can speak with animals (such as through ***Nature's Tongues***) can try to convince it to come willingly with a successful **Presence Roll (Difficulty 18)**.

The Al-Thueban can be in different places throughout the carnival depending if an event is taking place.

Carnival Timetable

The Snake's Arrival
The Al-Thueban first arrives in a flying cart guarded by **1 Carnival Constable** and **1 Carnival Conjurer.**

The cart emerges from a portal in the sky above the carnival and glides toward the back of the Big Top.

Once the Al-Thueban is captured, the **Velvet Daggers**, a rival thieving crew, will make their move. Move on to **ACT III: THE RIVALS.**

The Parade
About halfway through the carnival, a parade begins, and the Al-Thueban is brought out to perform a flying display.

Players can take this opportunity to capture the Al-Thueban.

Once the Al-Thueban is captured, the **Velvet Daggers**, a rival thieving crew, will make their move. Move on to **ACT III: THE RIVALS.**

The Big Top Show
The carnival ends with a grand circus performance inside the Big Top. A series of acts take the stage while the Al-Thueban flies in wide circles above the crowd.

This is the party's final opportunity to capture it.

Once the Al-Thueban is captured, the **Velvet Daggers**, a rival thieving crew, will make their move. Move on to **ACT III: THE RIVALS.**

The Planar Warehouse
When the Al-Thueban isn't performing, it's kept in the Planar Warehouse behind the Big Top. Entry requires a secret passphrase that changes daily.

The passphrase for today is: **"Three turtles juggle stardust while the axolotl counts backward from purple."**

Players can learn it by eavesdropping on staff or convincing one to share it with a successful **Presence Roll (Difficulty 20).**

Inside, **1 Carnival Constable, 1 Carnival Clown** and **1 Carnival Conjurer** stand guard.

The Al-Thueban is kept in a cage that can be lockpicked with a successful **Finesse Roll (Difficulty 14).**

Once the Al-Thueban is captured, the **Velvet Daggers**, a rival thieving crew, will make their move. Move on to **ACT III: THE RIVALS.**

THE Al-Thueban
The Al-Thueban is a massive, magical flying serpent. The Vaultbreakers Association wants it for its diamond-shelled eggs — though they keep that detail from the party.

When players first see the Al-Thueban up close read this out to them:

> The Al-Thueban is a massive serpent with a long, muscular body covered in opalescent scales of pearl and pale gold. A ridged frill runs down its spine, with fin-like crests at its neck. Its narrow face bears curved fangs and bright, gemlike eyes.

THE RIVALS

ACT III

Creating a Rival Team

Depending on the number of players you have, the rival team will look different. Use the following as a guide when creating the Velvet Daggers:

3 Players:
1. Leader
2. Bruiser
3. Standard or Ranged or Skulk

4 Players:
1. Leader
2. Bruiser
3. Standard or Ranged or Skulk
4. Support

5 Players:
1. Leader
2. Bruiser
3. Standard or Ranged or Skulk
4. Standard or Ranged or Skulk (That you didn't pick before)
5. Support

The Velvet Daggers

Leader: Rozen (she/her)
Highborne Infernis
Rozen is a burgundy Infernis with a sharp crimson rapier and a sharper tongue. The Velvet Daggers' spokesperson, she's effortlessly charming, until she decides not to be.

Bruiser: Bastion (he/him)
Orderborne Clank
Bastion is a hulking copper Clank with disproportionately large fists. He is usually quiet but enjoys a good laugh, often chuckling at Rozen's insults.

Standard: Blaxen Ceroth (he/him)
Seaborne Drakona
Blaxen is a brash red Drakona raised by pirates. Loud and rough-mannered, he wields a flaming sword with real skill—and never lets anyone forget it.

Skulk: Stari Amberhide (she/her)
Slyborne Katari
Stari is a sharp-eyed Katari with an auburn coat and deadly, well-kept claws. Slow to trust and always hunting for the angle, she misses little.

Ranged: Iris (they/them)
Wildborne Faerie
Iris is a lively faerie with iridescent dragonfly wings and endless energy. They talk fast, move faster, and leap at any chance for action, sky or battlefield.

Support: Septoria Acuform(she/them)
Loreborne Fungril
Septoria is a pale Fungril with sticky gems dotting their shifting cap. They speak slowly, offering strange wisdom laced with dry humor.

Use these descriptions to aid roleplaying the Velvet Daggers.

Rival Run-in

When the party finally captures the Al-Thueban, the Velvet Daggers, who want the serpent too, move in. Let them trade a few words, then start the encounter.

Encounter
- **Created Rival Team**

THE COMPLICATION

ACT IV

The Axolari Attack

Once the players recover the Al-Thueban and defeat the Velvet Daggers, they can begin their escape.

As soon as they attempt to leave, trigger the Axolari attack.

Read this aloud to them:

> As you attempt your escape, a thunderous boom echoes across the carnival grounds. The sound rolls through the air like cracking stone, and when you turn toward it, you see a massive portal tearing open in the sky above the tents. Its edges burn with shifting light as something enormous bursts through.
>
> A giant crab-shaped vessel shoots out of the rift, it streaks downward before slamming into the earth in a heavy, controlled landing that rattles the surrounding attractions.
>
> A hatch at the front of the vessel splits open, and figures begin pouring out — humanoid axolotls clad in red leather armor, barbed spears clutched tightly in their webbed hands. Their slick skin glistens under the carnival lights as they fan out across the grounds.
>
> At their head strides a larger, more imposing axolotl, armored more heavily and carrying a wicked spear. It raises its weapon and points toward the nearest attraction, letting out a sharp, echoing war cry.

The circus erupts into chaos as the Axolari attack indiscriminately, tearing through anyone and anything they see.

In the confusion, the players must decide: use the chaos to slip away unnoticed, or stand their ground and help repel the Axolari assault.

ESCAPING
The players may choose to use the chaos as cover and attempt to escape.

If they do, you may **spend 1 Fear** to have them intercepted by **1 Axolari Soldier Horde** during their retreat.

HELPING SAVE THE CIRCUS
If the players choose to save the circus, they must stand and fight against the invading Axolari.

To end the assault, they will need to defeat Torrent, the Axolari leader, whose command holds the attack together.

Encounter
- **Torrent the Axolari**
- **2 Axolari Soldier Horde**

Defeating Torrent causes the Axolari assault to collapse instantly.

With their leader fallen, the remaining forces break off and retreat to the Carapiercer — their flying crab-ship — before tearing open a portal and fleeing the carnival.

ONWARDS!
Once players successfully escape the carnival grounds or defeat the attacking Axolari, proceed to **ACT V: THE EXFILTRATION**.

THE EXFILTRATION

ACT V

How exfiltration goes depends on how the heist played out. There are three options: **Leaving Undetected, Escaping Pursuit** or **With a Reward.**

Leaving Undetected

If players are wily enough to leave with the Al-Thueban without alerting any carnival staff members they can leave completely undetected and are **HOMEFREE!**

Escaping Pursuit

If the players get noticed escaping with the Al-Thueban, Curio will chase after the party themself.

Start a **Progress Countdown (4)** for the PCs' escape and a **Consequence Countdown (6)** for their capture. If the PCs are caught, they'll have to fight their way out.

Encounter:

- **Curio the Genie**

Once they deal with Curio they are **HOMEFREE!**

With a Reward

In the case that the party helped deal with the Axolari Invasion they will be approached by Curio.

Curio thanks them and offers them one gift from anything they want as long as the Carnival has it.

Players can ask for anything sensible and Curio would be happy to reward them with such.

However if players ask for the Al-Thueban they will need to succeed on a **Presence Roll (Difficulty 14)** for Curio to accept this request.

If they manage to convince Curio to give them the Al-Thueban they are **HOMEFREE!**

Homefree!

Back at their hideout, the shadowy Vaultbreakers handler appears again, a small rift open beside them to receive the Containment Pearl.

Once the players place the Containment Pearl into the rift, read the following aloud:

> The rift collapses the moment the Containment Pearl vanishes within it.
>
> The projected figure pauses, then nods their head in approval.
>
> "The task is complete. The client's expectations have been met. Now for your reward."
>
> Space warps beside the table as a second breach opens, depositing two reinforced chests onto the floor.
>
> "This concludes our arrangement. The Vaultbreakers favor operatives who deliver. You will hear from us again."

The party receives **2 Chests** as payment.

Congratulations!

The heist was a success! You've completed **Vaultbreakers: Curio's Conjured Carnival.**

ADVERSARIES

Appendix A

Carnival Constable

Tier 1 Standard
Uniformed guards with metal batons, eyes always scanning the crowd.
Motives & Tactics: Maintain order, patrol the carnival, subdue rabblerousers

Difficulty: 15 | **Thresholds:** 9/17 |
HP: 4 | **Stress:** 4
ATK: +2 | **Club:** Melee | 2d8+4 phy

Experience: Defence +2

FEATURES
Reinforce - Action: Mark a Stress to move into Melee range of an ally and make a standard attack against a target within Very Close range. On a success, deal **2d10+2** physical damage and the ally can clear a Stress.
Staggering Strike - Action: Make an attack against a target within Melee range. On a success, spend a Fear to deal **2d6+2** physical damage and temporarily make them *Vulnerable.*

Carnival Clown

Tier 1 Skulk
Brightly dressed clowns with red noses and painted faces, moving playfully but hiding sharp blades.
Motives & Tactics: Entertain the carnival goers, dash in and out

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 8/16 |
HP: 4 | **Stress:** 4
ATK: +3 | **Sickle:** Melee | 2d8+2 phy

Experience: Acrobatics +2

FEATURES
Mocking Tone - Passive: During combat, the clown hurls constant, distracting jokes at the players. PCs who can hear them have a -1 to Evasion.
Acrobatic Defense - Reaction: When a creature moves into Melee range to make an attack, you can **mark a Stress** before the attack roll to move anywhere within Close range and make an attack against that creature. On a success, deal **1d10+2** physical damage.

Carnival Conjurer

Tier 1 Support
Magicians in cloaks and top hats, wielding wands and summoning rabbits for show or defense.
Motives & Tactics: Protect the carnival, let the rabbit pack attack

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 8/16 |
HP: 4 | **Stress:** 5
ATK: +2 | **Magicians Wand:** Far | 2d4+3 mag

Experience: Magic Tricks +2

FEATURES
Draining Blast - Action: Spend a Fear to make a standard attack against a target within range. On a success, the target must mark a Stress.
Summon Rabbits - Reaction: Once per scene, when the conjurer marks 1 or more HP, you can mark a Stress to summon a Conjured Rabbit Pack, which appears at Close range and is immediately spotlighted.

Conjured Rabbit Pack

Tier 2 Horde (2/HP)
A group of small, magical rabbits with glowing eyes and twitching ears. They dart unpredictably, multiplying and weaving through combat with surprising speed.
Motives & Tactics: Consume, swarm

Difficulty: 13 | **Thresholds:** 8/15 |
HP: 4 | **Stress:** 3
ATK: +0 | **Teeth:** Melee | 2d6+3 mag

Experience: Swarming +5

FEATURES
Horde (1d6+3) - Passive: When the Rabbits have marked half or more of their HP, their standard attack deals **1d6+3** damage instead.
Bunny Stampede - Active: **Spend a Fear** and pick a group within Very Close range. The rabbit Pack can move up to Close range passing by the group. Creatures in the group must succeed on an Agility Reaction Roll to avoid the pack or take 2d8+2 phys.
Summon Shattering - Reaction: When the Pack marks their last HP, the magic that makes them up shatters. Make an attack against all targets within Very Close range. Targets the Pack succeeds against take 2d12+2 magic damage

Curio the Genie

Tier 2 Solo
An eccentric genie who runs the Conjured Carnival.
Motives & Tactics: Entertain, make a spectacle

Difficulty: 15 | **Thresholds:** 14/26 |
HP: 9 | **Stress:** 6
ATK: +3 | **Magic Blast:** Far | 2d6+3 mag

Experience: Entertainment +5

FEATURES
Relentless (3) - Passive: Curio can be spotlighted up to three times per GM turn. Spend Fear as usual to spotlight them.
This is my Domain - Passive: *While in the Carnival Grounds Curio has a +1 to their difficulty and +1 to all rolls they make.*
Self-Fulfilling Wish - Action: *Countdown (Loop 6)* At the start of a scenario that involves combat with Curio trigger this countdown, Curio will wish for good health. When it triggers Curio regains all health lost.
Lower Gravity - Action: **Mark a Stress** to lift up a target into the air within Close range of their original position. They are temporarily *Restrained* and *Vulnerable* there. Upon escaping they must succeed on an Agility roll to land safely or take **1d20+5** physical damage from the fall. On a success they take half damage.

Tangleblight

Tier 2 Skulk
Living vines that try to grab unknowing creatures and pull them underwater.
Motives & Tactics: Grab unsuspecting victims, drag victims down into water

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 8/16 |
HP: 4 | **Stress:** 4
ATK: +5 | Vine Lash: Close | 2d6+2 phy

Experience: Grappling +2

FEATURES
Grappling Strike - Action: After making a successful attack against a target, you can spend a fear to temporarily *Restrain* the target.
Blend In - Reaction: When the Tangleblight makes a successful attack, you can **mark a Stress** to become *Hidden* until the Tangleblight's next attack or a PC succeeds on an **Instinct Roll (14)** to find them.

Al-Thueban

Tier 2 Solo
A huge flying serpent that weaves through the sky with ease and grace.
Motives & Tactics: Fly, be free, swoop in and out

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 13/27 |
HP: 10 | **Stress:** 5
ATK: +3 | **Bite:** Melee | 2d6+3 phy

Experience: Aerial Acrobatics +5

FEATURES
Relentless (2) - Passive: The Al-Thueban can be spotlighted up to two times per GM turn. Spend Fear as usual to spotlight them
Agile Flight - Passive: While flying, the Al-Thueban has a +2 bonus to its Difficulty and advantage on Agility Reaction Rolls.
Venomous Bite - Passive: Targets who mark HP from the Al-Thueban's attacks are Vulnerable until they clear a HP.
Diamond Scales - Reaction: On a successful attack within Melee range against the Al-Thueban, you can spend 2 Fear to have the attacker mark an Armor Slot without receiving its benefits (they can still use armor to reduce the damage). If they can't mark an Armor Slot, they must mark an additional HP.

Reflection Revenant

Tier 2 Skulk
Creatures made of glass that aim to copy, kill and replace their victims.
Motives & Tactics: Replace the Original, Explore the world

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 8/16 |
HP: 4 | **Stress:** 8
ATK: +2 | **Copied Weapon:** Varies | Copied Weapon Damage

Experience: Copying +2

FEATURES
Perfect Reflection - Active: At the start of a scene the Revenant copies one chosen PC it can see. It copies the weapon the PC carries including its Range, Damage and Damage Type.
I am You and You are I: **Mark a Stress** to use one of the copied PC's Domain Card Ability. If the ability requires stress mark extra stress accordingly, if it requires HP mark HP accordingly and if it requires Hope, spend Fear instead. The Revenant also follows limitations.

Rozen (Rival Leader)

Tier 2 Leader
A burgundy Infernis with plentiful gold jewelry adorning her body. She is the leader of the Velvet Daggers.
Motives & Tactics: Coordinate, taunt

Difficulty: 15 | **Thresholds:** 12/24 |
HP: 7 | **Stress:** 5
ATK: +4 | **Red Rapier:** Melee | 2d8+3 phy

Experience: Coordinating +3, Taunting +3

FEATURES
Coordination - Action: **Spend 2 Fear** to spotlight Rozen and **1d4** allies within far range.
Don't Stop Staring - Action: **Mark a Stress** to *Daze* a target within far range until they mark any number of HP or **mark 2 stress** to end the condition. While *Dazed* a target is *Vulnerable* and can't make any action rolls while spotlighted or reaction rolls.
Momentum - Reaction: When Rozen makes a successful attack against a PC, you gain a Fear.

Bastion (Rival Bruiser)

Tier 2 Bruiser
A hulking copper clank with disproportionately large fists. He is the guardian in the Velvet Daggers.
Motives & Tactics: Intimidate, protect his crew, smash obstacles

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 14/28 |
HP: 8 | **Stress:** 6
ATK: +2 | **Metal Fists:** Very Close | 2d10+3 phy

Experience: Body Guard +3

FEATURES
Ramp Up - Passive: You must **spend a Fear** to spotlight Bastion. While spotlighted, they can make their standard attack against all targets within range.
Thunderwave - Action: Mark a Stress *to blast targets back. All targets within Very Close range must succeed on an Agility Reaction Roll or take* ***2d6*** *magical damage and be knocked back to Close Range.*
What Doesn't Kill… - Reaction: *When hit* ***mark any number of Stress*** *to reduce the HP to be marked by the same amount.*

Blaxen Ceroth (Rival Standard)

Tier 2 Standard
A red-scaled Drakona with numerous battle scars. He is the warrior in the Velvet Daggers.
Motives & Tactics: Prove strength, dominate foes, uphold the Velvet Daggers' reputation

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 9/18 |
HP: 6 | **Stress:** 4
ATK: +2 | **Flamesword:** Melee | 2d6+4 phy/mag

Experience: Swordfighting +3

FEATURES
Dragon's Breath - Action: **Spend a Fear to** make an attack against all targets within Very Close range. On a success, the target takes **1d4** magic damage and is temporarily *Ignited*. While *Ignited*, the target takes **1d4** magic damage when they make an action roll.
Flaming Parry - Reaction: When a creature is to hit Blaxen, **mark a stress** to add +2 to his difficulty potentially preventing damage and deal **1d4** direct magic damage to the creature

Iris (Rival Ranged)

Tier 2 Ranged
An energetic dragonfly-winged faerie. They are the ranger in the Velvet Daggers.
Motives & Tactics: Show off agility, outmaneuver opponents, strike from unexpected angles

Difficulty: 11 | **Thresholds:** 6/14 |
HP: 3 | **Stress:** 2
ATK: +2 | **Faerie-Longbow:** Far | 2d8+3 phy

Experience: Aerial Combat +3

FEATURES
Flight - Passive: While flying, Iris gains a +2 bonus to their Difficulty.
Aerial Aim - Passive: When Iris succeeds on a standard attack from above a target, they deal **1d10+4** physical damage instead of their standard damage.

Stari Amberhide (Rival Skulk)

Tier 2 Skulk
An auburn Katari with a long bushy tail and long, sharpened claws. She is the rogue in the party.
Motives & Tactics: Hunt silently, strike from shadows, isolate targets

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 8/17 |
HP: 4 | **Stress:** 4
ATK: +3 | **Sharpened Claws:** Melee | 2d4+4 phy

Experience: Stealth +3

FEATURES
Quick Reactions - Passive: Stari has advantage on Agility and Finesse reaction rolls. Attacks Far range or farther against her are at disadvantage against her.
Bleeding Scratch - Action: When Stari hits with her Sharpened Claws, she can **mark a Stress** to cause the target to temporarily *Bleed*. While *Bleeding*, the target **marks a Stress** when they make an action roll.

Septoria Acuform (Rival Support)

Tier 2 Support
A sparkling Fungril with sticky gems plastered all over her mushroom cap. She is the Witch in the Velvet Daggers.
Motives & Tactics: Hex enemies, boost allies

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 9/18 |
HP: 5 | **Stress:** 6
ATK: +2 | **Moldy Staff:** Far | 2d6+4 mag

Experience: Witchcraft +3

FEATURES
Moldy Beam - Action: **Spend a Fear** to make a standard attack against a target within range. On a success, the target must mark a Stress.
Sparkling Spores - Action: **Spend a Fear** to spray Sparkling Spores on targets within Close range. All targets within this area must succeed on an Agility reaction roll or become temporarily *revealed.* When *Revealed* a target is *Vulnerable* and can't gain the *Hidden* condition.

Axolari Warrior Horde

Tier 2 Horde (2/HP)
A battalion of Axolari after the Conjured Carnival. They destroy the carnival as retaliation.
Motives & Tactics: Enact revenge, destroy

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 7/16 |
HP: 5 | **Stress:** 4
ATK: +2 | **Spear:** Very Close | 2d6+3 phy

Experience: Swordfighting +3

FEATURES
Horde (1d6+3) - Passive: When the horde has marked half or more of their HP, their standard attack deals 1d6+3 damage instead.
Telepathic Resonance - Passive: If the Axolari makes a successful standard attack and another ally is within Very Close range of the target, deal **2d6+5** physical damage instead of their standard damage and you gain a Fear.
Psychic Feedback - Reaction: When a creature hits the Axolari Horde, **spend a Fear** to have the attacker mark a stress.

Torrent The Axolari

Tier 2 Leader
The leader of the Axolari battalion after the Conjured Carnival. He is determined to get revenge.
Motives & Tactics: Flex strength, get revenge, command troops

Difficulty: 16 | **Thresholds:** 15/27 |
HP: 6 | **Stress:** 4
ATK: +5 | **Spear:** Very Close | 2d10+3 phy

Experience: One on One Combat +3

FEATURES
Telepathic Resonance - Passive: If Torrent makes a successful standard attack and another ally is within Very Close range of the target, deal **2d10+5** physical damage instead of their standard damage and you gain a Fear.
Rally Warriors - Action: Spend 2 Fear to spotlight Torrent and up to 2d4 allies within Far range.
Dreadful Swing - Action: **Mark a Stress** to make an attack against targets within Very Close range. Targets that are hit take 2d12+4, mark a stress and lose a Hope.
Momentum - Reaction: When Torrent makes a successful attack against a PC, you gain a Fear.

ITEMS

Appendix B

Arcane Cloak
A creature with a Spellcast trait wearing this cloak can adjust its color, texture, and size at will.

Arcane Facepaint
This facepaint lets you appear as any humanoid you can clearly picture. While disguised, you have advantage on Presence Rolls to avoid suspicion.

You gain 3 tokens. Each time you take an action while disguised, spend 1 token. When the last token is spent and the action resolves, the disguise fades.

Containment Pearl
Throw this pearl at a creature within Close range with a Finesse Roll. On a hit, the target must make a roll (Agility if a PC) **(Difficulty 11)** or be trapped. Creatures below half health roll with disadvantage.

Calming Pendant
When you would mark your last Stress, roll a d6. On a result of 5 or higher, don't mark it.

Gecko Gloves
You can climb up vertical surfaces and across ceilings.

Ghost Gaze Goggles
Spend 2 Hope to see through a solid surface, like a wall, for a few seconds.

Glamour Stone
Activate this pebble-sized stone to memorize the appearance of someone you can see. Spend a Hope to magically recreate this guise on yourself as an illusion.

Lakestrider Boots
You can walk on the surface of water as if it were soft ground.

Major Charm Potion
Drink to gain a +1 bonus to your Presence until your next rest.

Minor Health Potion
Drink to Clear 1d4 HP.

Minor Stamina Potion
Drink to Clear 1d4 Stress

Ring of Silence
Spend a Hope to activate this ring. Your footsteps are silent until your next rest.

Ser Cuddles
A teddy bear dressed as a knight. Squeeze it to clear 2 Stress once per Long Rest.

Self Wrapping Rope
Spend 1 Hope to have the rope automatically knot or extend as needed for climbing and binding.

Lorekeeper
You can store the name and details of up to three hostile creatures inside this book. You gain a +1 bonus to action rolls against those creatures.

Speaking Orbs
This pair of orbs allows any creatures holding them to communicate with each other across any distance.

Water Sprite in a Bag
This tiny sprite swims in a small bag of water. Once per long rest, you can observe the sprites swimming and gain 2 Hope.